Michael A. Okonji

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Summary

Highly accomplished technology professional with 11+ years of diverse experience, culminating in 5+ years specializing as an AWS Cloud Engineer / Platform Engineer with a software engineering background, designing and maintaining large-scale production infrastructure. Experienced in designing secure AWS network architectures (VPC, IAM), implementing high-availability systems, and operating production workloads with strong observability, backup/recovery, and cost-awareness. Expert in developing and managing CI/CD pipelines using AWS native tools (CodePipeline, CodeBuild, CodeDeploy) and Infrastructure as Code (CloudFormation, CDK, Terraform). Proven track record in optimizing complex cloud environments through advanced scripting (Python, Bash) and implementing resilient, event-driven serverless architectures. Experienced in operating cloud workloads with strong security, compliance awareness, and operational controls.

Professional Experience

Software Development Engineer *June 2025 – Present*
AMAZON WEB SERVICES, DALLAS, TX

- Built and operated customer-facing AWS services leveraging core competencies in Java and Python, consistently shipping features to meet sprint milestones for critical AWS cloud products.
- Spearheaded CI/CD buildout utilizing AWS CodePipeline + CodeBuild across beta/gamma/prod stages, achieving significant reductions in release friction and cycle time.
- Optimized service communication by replacing constant AWS Lambda polling with event-driven SNS pub/sub flow, resulting in a 70% reduction in response time and computing overhead, improving both performance and operational cost efficiency.
- Developed robust AWS CDK (TypeScript) stacks to provision and standardize application infrastructure, including VPC resources, IAM roles, networking, and runtime configurations, significantly reducing environment setup time and enforcing best practices.
- Designed and enforced least-privilege IAM roles and policies for services and CI/CD pipelines, improving security posture while enabling safe automated deployments.
- Partnered closely with Product Managers and engineers in Agile sprints to define feature scope, de-risk technical dependencies, and ensure iterative delivery.
- Drove root-cause analysis and postmortems for complex production incidents across distributed services and cloud infrastructure, identifying reliability gaps and driving improvements to availability and fault tolerance.
- Implemented monitoring and alerting using Amazon CloudWatch metrics, logs, and alarms to improve service visibility and reduce mean time to detection for production issues.

Cloud Support Engineer – Deployment *2022 – June 2025*
AMAZON WEB SERVICES, DALLAS, TX

- Debugged software solutions utilizing the core AWS observability tools such as CloudTrail and CloudWatch and developed Infrastructure as Code solutions using CloudFormation and AWS CDK apps, implemented in Python or Typescript.
- Advised enterprise customers on AWS architecture best practices, including VPC design, IAM strategy, CI/CD automation, and highly available service deployments.
- Authored automation scripts utilizing Python and Bash to streamline deployments, configuration management, and observability processes.
- Supported enterprise customers with operational best practices across AWS Backup, EC2 recovery workflows, and disaster recovery readiness.

- Assisted with infrastructure maintenance and patching strategies using AWS Systems Manager to support secure production operations.
- Provided high-level technical support for global enterprise developer customers across support tickets, direct calls, and live chat engagements.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with Solutions Architects and Technical account managers to design scalable and resilient solutions for Fortune 500 customers.
- Authored comprehensive internal documentation and knowledge base articles to streamline best practices for the AWS Cloud Engineering team.
- Participated in incident response and operational escalation workflows to maintain service availability.

DevOps Admin, IBM DataStage Admin, Google Cloud Admin *2018 – 2022*
BOEING, NORTH CHARLESTON, SC

- Automated provisioning, deployment, and configuration of IBM DataStage environments across Development, Test, and Production using Ansible and Infrastructure as Code practices, significantly reducing manual intervention and improving deployment consistency.
- Implemented Terraform modules to provision and manage supporting infrastructure components, enabling repeatable and standardized environment builds.
- Provided key administrative support for Google Cloud Platform (GCP) projects, building Proofs of Concept (POCs) and scripting solutions for multi-environment architecture.
- Led the development of Ansible automation scripts specifically for provisioning IBM DataStage environments across Development, Test, and Production tiers.
- Executed patching and maintenance across Linux production systems, reducing unplanned downtime by 20%.

SQL Server Database Administrator *2016 – February 2019*
BOEING, NORTH CHARLESTON, SC

- Automated critical database operations by programming T-SQL batch scripts for scheduled backups, retention policy enforcement, and performance tuning routines.
- Maintained 24/7 on-call support coverage, executing advanced troubleshooting and resolution for high-priority production database servers.
- Designed, developed, and scheduled SSIS packages to manage complex ETL processes, significantly improving data synchronization fidelity between business units.
- Collaborated with application and infrastructure teams to strategically plan and execute database migration projects, minimizing service disruption.

Database Administrator *August 2014 – November 2015*
INFINITE CONSULTANTS LLC, SNELLVILLE, GA

- Provided comprehensive administration and tuning support for SQL Server databases across development, test, and production environments for a diverse client portfolio.
- Managed and executed key database migration projects, successfully transitioning SQL Server instances across various client infrastructure updates.
- Implemented robust log shipping solutions for disaster recovery preparedness and configured critical alerts for replication tasks to ensure data integrity.
- Executed installation, configuration, patching, and version upgrades for SQL Server 2008 and 2012 platforms.

Education

Python Programming Certificate *May 2020*
SAINT LOUIS UNIVERSITY, MO

SQL700 – 003 SQL Performance Tuning and Optimization *March 2017*
SAINT LOUIS UNIVERSITY, MO

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, GPA: 3.24 ; WES Ref# 4352103IMM *September 2012*
TANSIAN UNIVERSITY, UMUNYA, NIGERIA

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

AWS Cloud Engineering & Networking: EC2, VPC, IAM, ALB/NLB, Route 53 (DNS), Transit Gateway

Cloud Operations & Monitoring: CloudWatch, AWS Backup, Systems Manager (SSM), Patch Manager

DevOps & Automation: CloudFormation, Terraform, AWS CDK, CodePipeline, CodeBuild, CodeDeploy

Containers: ECS, EKS, Docker, Kubernetes

Scripting & Administration: Bash, Python, PowerShell (basic), Red Hat Linux, Windows Server

Cost Optimization: Cost Explorer, AWS Budgets, Tagging strategies

Database Technologies: SQL Server, PostgreSQL.

Certifications

- AWS Certified DevOps Engineer – Professional
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate
- AWS Accredited CloudFormation Subject Matter Expert - Credly Badge (November 2023)
- Google Cloud Certified Associate Cloud Engineer
- Oracle Certified Associate, Java SE 8 Programmer - Oracle certview
- Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP) 70-764: Administering a Microsoft SQL Database Infrastructure (2016)
- AWS Tech U Graduate
- MTA Database Fundamentals